

Before you book the shipment

Planning worksheet for discussion with your US customs broker and relevant product specialist. Requirements vary by product and shipment.

This checklist is not legal clearance, an exhaustive compliance determination or a guarantee of customs release. The importer remains responsible for compliance; engage a broker or specialist to confirm obligations for the actual goods. [1]

01 / CONFIRM RESPONSIBILITIES AND FILINGS

CHECK	POINT TO CONFIRM WITH YOUR BROKER / SPECIALIST
☐ Importer and broker	Importer of record, identification, broker authorization and the entry route.
☐ Classification and value	HTS classification, origin, valuation, duties and any additional measures that apply.
☐ Bond and entry needs	Whether a bond, formal entry or other filing is required for this shipment.
☐ Ocean security filing	Confirm ISF applicability, data owner and filing deadlines well before loading. Use current CBP guidance. [2]
☐ Product requirements	Identify applicable agencies, labelling and evidence. Medical-device requirements depend on the actual device and activity. [3]
☐ Packaging and origin	Confirm country-of-origin marking and any regulated wood-packaging treatment / marking obligations. [4]
☐ Shipment handover	Confirm delivery terms, consignee, documents, freight booking and the party responsible for each step.

Broker / specialist contact and outstanding questions

Review the document set

Order / shipment reference: _____ Review date: _____

02 / CHECK APPLICABLE RECORDS FOR CONSISTENCY

RECORD	REVIEW POINT
[] Commercial invoice	Accurate description, quantities, value, currency and parties; discuss required details with the broker.
[] Packing list	Package counts, item quantities, weights and dimensions reconcile with the shipment.
[] Transport document	Bill of lading or air waybill details match the intended shipper, consignee and routing.
[] Origin evidence	Maintain origin records; confirm if a separate certificate or other evidence is needed.
[] Product records	Obtain the product-specific test, registration, listing, authorization or other records that apply.
[] Filing confirmation	Confirm required submissions and responses with the responsible filing party. Retain the applicable records.

For medical devices, registration/listing is distinct from clearance or approval. Verify the manufacturer, device and required regulatory route; a supplier brochure is not a substitute for the applicable records. [3]

PRIMARY SOURCES / CHECKED 11 SEPTEMBER 2026

[1] CBP: importer responsibility and customs brokers
https://www.help.cbp.gov/s/article/Article-1169?language=en_US

[2] CBP: Importer Security Filing timing
<https://www.help.cbp.gov/s/article/Article-1868>

[3] FDA: importing medical devices
<https://www.fda.gov/industry/importing-fda-regulated-products/importing-medical-devices>

[4] CBP: wood packaging requirements
https://www.help.cbp.gov/s/article/Article-1200?language=en_US